

100,000 users in 12 months.

Bootstrap budget · global English-speaking · zero paid acquisition. A go-to-market plan that tells the truth about the math first, then works backwards to the channels that close the gap.

ORGANIC-FIRST · CONTENT-LED · COMMUNITY-COMPOUNDING

Executive Summary

Lazy Launcher is an Android home-screen replacement that asks one tiny question every time you unlock and converts that data into habit-building loops. Tasks gate apps. Friction gates distraction. Points record everything.

THE OPPORTUNITY

Average smartphone use is 4h 37m/day (Data.ai, 2024). 71% of US adults feel overwhelmed by their phones (Pew, 2023). The digital-wellness category will triple from \$5.3B → \$20B by 2030. There are credible alternatives but none combine ambient capture, a real point economy, and intercepts in a single Android launcher.

THE WEDGE

Existing tools either block (Opal, Cold Turkey) or strip (Olauncher, Minimalist Phone). Lazy Launcher does both, then adds the things they don't: tasks that unlock apps, points you spend like time, Sad-Self interventions on time, a 72-hour anti-uninstall flow. It hurts to leave. That's the moat.

THE PLAN

Bootstrap. Three big launches (Product Hunt, HackerNews, Reddit waves) + sustained content (twice-weekly threads, monthly long-form blog) + 5–10 creator collabs across the year. Word-of-mouth amplified by group features. 100,000 users by month 12, \$0–\$2k total spend, mostly tools and merch.

THE HONEST PART

100k bootstrap in Y1 is a stretch. Olauncher took ~24 months. Forest took ~6 years. We have viral mechanics (groups, dual streaks, surrender posts) and a sharp narrative the press already wants to tell. The plan models what has to be true: one Product-Hunt #1, one HN front-page, three viral threads, one 7-figure-view TikTok, and 70%+ day-7 retention.

USERS · Y1

100k

cumulative

PAID SPEND

\$0

organic only

LAUNCH EVENTS

3

PH / HN / Press

TOTAL Y1 COSTS

\$2k

tools + cloud

Market & Opportunity

THE PHONE-OVERUSE EPIDEMIC, IN NUMBERS

DAILY AVG

4h 37m

smartphone time, 2024 (Data.ai)

UNLOCKS / DAY

58x

median knowledge worker

FEEL OVERWHELMED

71%

US adults (Pew, 2023)

MKT TODAY

\$5.3B

digital wellness, 2023

MKT BY 2030

\$20B

projected CAGR 21%

POST-2020

+470%

anti-social app DLs (Sensor Tower)

WHY NOW

Three forces are converging. (1) Cultural fatigue with the engagement economy — there is now a thriving genre of "I quit Instagram" essays. (2) Hardware experiments (Brick, Light Phone, Unpluq) have proven a willingness to pay for friction. (3) On-device LLMs (Gemini Nano, Apple Intelligence) make ambient capture finally feasible without sending every meal photo to a cloud.

WHERE THE USER LIVES

The buyer is reachable on four surfaces: Reddit (r/digitalminimalism 130k, r/dumbphones 240k, r/getdisciplined 1.5M, r/productivity 950k), Twitter/X (focus / productivity / build-in-public clusters), YouTube (Ali Abdaal, Matt D'Avella, Better Ideas, Cal Newport's audience), and TikTok (#dopaminedetox 4.1B views, #digitaldetox 3.2B views).

ADJACENT SPENDS

The user is already paying for: Headspace/Calm (\$70/yr), Notion/Obsidian (free → \$96/yr), a Kindle (\$120), a journal (\$25), a habit-tracker (Habitica/Streaks \$50/yr), occasionally a Brick (\$120) or an Unpluq (\$50). A \$5–8/mo premium for a launcher that closes the loop on all of the above is comfortably within their budget.

Competitor Landscape

The market is fragmented into three pieces: minimal launchers (no behavioral system), blockers / hardware (one mechanic), and habit trackers (the engagement flavor of the very thing the user is trying to escape). Lazy Launcher is the first to combine the launcher, the intercepts, the economy, and the social accountability in a single Android-native package.

PRODUCT

CATEGORY

USERS

PRICE

GAP WE EXPLOIT

Forest

focus timer

3M+

\$3.99

no launcher · single mechanic

Opal

screen-time blocker

1M+

\$60/yr

iOS-first · no economy · no launcher

Olauncher

minimal launcher

~500k

free

no intercepts · no points · no social

Minimalist Phone

minimal launcher

~200k

free / \$

no behavioral system

Niagara Launcher

minimal launcher

~3M

free / \$35

still engagement-flavored · no friction

Light Phone II/III

hardware

~50k

\$300

expensive · all-or-nothing

Brick

hardware

~50k

\$59

one mechanic · easy to bypass

Unplug

hardware

~50k

\$59

one mechanic · friction wears off

Freedom

blocker

~2M

\$40/yr

no ambient capture · desktop-first

Cold Turkey

blocker

~500k

\$39 one-time

no mobile-first story · no economy

Habitica

habit tracker

~4M

free / \$

no launcher · gamified for engagement, not for quitting

Streaks

habit tracker

~1M

\$5 once

no app control · no social · iOS-only

THE NARRATIVE WEDGE

"Other apps block your phone. Lazy Launcher makes you earn it." Productivity- anyone has seen the blocker pitch a thousand times. The earn-your-phone framing is fresh, points to the mechanic, and gives the press a story to write that isn't another digital-detox piece.

Target Personas

Four people, ranked by share of the first 100k installs and revenue contribution. We target the first two for paid; the second two are the volume + virality engine.

The Burned-Out Knowledge Worker

25–32 · Tech / finance / design · \$80–150k · SF, NYC, London, Toronto, Berlin

- scrolls 4–5h/day on phone
- identifies as 'should-be-doing-more'
- has tried Forest, Opal, deleting IG
- owns AirPods, Kindle, an analog journal

BUYS Premium (\$6/mo) for backup, AI insights, group features.

REACH Reddit r/digitalminimalism · X (focus + productivity clusters) · Cal Newport's audience

VOICE speak to the 'I'm wasting my potential' anxiety, not the screen-time stat.

The Maker / Indie

22–35 · Designer / dev / writer / artist · solo or small team · ships side projects

- identifies as a 'builder'
- uses Notion / Obsidian / Linear
- actively consumes 5h+/day
- follows Pieter Levels, Daniel Vassallo, Andrej Karpathy

BUYS Premium for the data export, public builder profile, dual streaks with friends.

REACH Twitter/X (build-in-public) · Indie Hackers · Lobsters · HackerNews

VOICE you are what you make. Receipts beat narratives. Build in public.

Target Personas

— continued —

The ADHD-Aware Student

18–24 · University or first job · cash-poor but time-rich · openly diagnosed/self-diagnosed ADHD

- dopamine-fried, knows it
- has tried 6+ productivity apps and abandoned them
- shares mental-health openly
- uses TikTok heavily but hates the habit

BUYS Free tier indefinitely. Word-of-mouth multiplier — they tell 5 friends.

REACH TikTok #dopaminedetox · r/ADHD · r/getdisciplined · YouTube short-form

VOICE skip the productivity gospel. Show the receipts. Be honest about how hard it is.

The Recovering Doomscroller

26–45 · any role · just had a wake-up moment (kid, breakup, health scare, job loss)

- religious-level commitment to quitting
- needs accountability not motivation
- would pay for hardware (Brick, Light Phone)
- tells friends, posts the journey

BUYS Premium + Lifetime if offered. Money Stake adopter.

REACH press (Wired, Verge), long-form blogs, Medium, Substack

VOICE no gimmicks. The app is on your side. You'll fail and the app expects that.

Positioning

THE ONE-LINE

Lazy Launcher. An Android launcher that asks one tiny thing every time you unlock — and quietly builds the habits you wish you had.

VARIANTS BY AUDIENCE

TO MAKERS

"Other apps block your phone. Lazy Launcher makes you earn it."

TO STUDENTS

"Your phone now asks one question per unlock. Three weeks in, the question is the habit."

TO TECH JOURNALISTS

"The first launcher built around loss aversion. It hurts to leave. That's the point."

TO YOUR DAD

"Replaces your home screen. The phone is quieter. You do less of the things that don't matter."

BRAND VOICE

say: honest, slightly mean, type-led, mathematically literate

avoid: hustle-bro, gamification-positive, productivity-porn

vibe: a friend who has just quit the same thing you want to quit

never: "limitless potential," "10x," "boss," "grind"

VISUAL IDENTITY

OLED black

warm orange (#FF6B35)

Inter Light / Bold

type-led, no icons

monospace receipts

sentence-only data

ANTI-POSITIONING

Not minimalism for aesthetics. Not gamification for engagement. Not productivity for identity. Not a wellness app for vibes. We're a behavioral substrate that happens to be a launcher. Press release tone: deadpan, never inspirational.

The 100,000 Math

Working backwards from 100,000 cumulative installs by month 12. We model a viral coefficient k between 0.3–0.5 driven by group features (dual streaks, surrender posts, shame notifications) and a 7-day retention of 55–70%.

THE FUNNEL

STAGE
RATE
NOTE
VOLUME
impression → click
2.5%
varies wildly across channels; PH/HN higher, X lower
—
click → Play Store visit
60%
decent landing page
—
visit → install
25%
category-typical for launchers
—
install → onboarded
55%
Lazy Launcher onboarding is heavy (20 min); expect drop
—
onboarded → day-7
62%
groups + sad self drive retention
—
day-7 → day-30
80%
category-typical for retained users

day-30 → year-1 viral

$k=0.4$

each retained user brings 0.4 new installs

WHAT MUST BE TRUE

Reach roughly **2.7M impressions** across the year, convert to **~270,000 store visits** → **~67,500 organic installs**. With $k=0.4$ compounding, the cumulative active base hits ~100k by month 12. Below $k=0.3$ we miss by ~30%. Above $k=0.5$ we hit 100k by month 8.

WHERE THE 2.7M COMES FROM

CHANNEL

IMPRESSIONS

%

Product Hunt launch (top 3 day)

120k

4.4%

HackerNews front page (Show HN)

180k

6.7%

Reddit (consistent posts × 50)

400k

14.8%

Twitter/X (build-in-public · 200 tweets)

350k

13.0%

YouTube collabs (8 videos × ~50k views)

400k

14.8%

TikTok organic (40+ videos · 1 hit)

700k

25.9%

Press (Wired/Verge/TechCrunch × 1–2)

300k

11.1%

Podcast appearances (5–8)

150k

5.6%

Word of mouth uncoun

100k

3.7%

TOTAL

~2.7M impressions

Channel Stack — Bootstrap

Seven channels, ranked by 100k-contribution. Every channel is organic and time-rich. Total cash budget across the year: tools and hosting, < \$2k.

Product Hunt launch

\$0 · 1 dedicated week to prep, 1 day launch

GOAL 5–15k installs in week 1, top-3 product of day

- build a hunter list of 200 supporters across X, Indie Hackers, Discord
- ship a launch video (90 sec) showing the unlock → todo → unlock loop
- Tuesday 12:01 AM PST launch · live in the comments for 14 hrs
- second-wave: HN Show post 48 hrs later with PH metrics as social proof

HackerNews launch + sustained presence

\$0 · 1 month build, 1 day launch + weekly drips

GOAL front page (~180k impressions), 5–15k installs, ongoing comments

- Show HN: build narrative around the point-economy mechanic (not features)
- release a 'How the Lobby works' technical post, open-source the lobby logic
- respond to every comment in the first 6 hours
- follow up monthly with technical pieces (form metric, voice-LLM journaling)

Reddit (4 subs × 12 posts / year)

\$0 · 1–2 posts / week

GOAL 10k installs cumulative · sustained inbound

- r/digitalminimalism · 130k · monthly long-form 'one month with Lazy Launcher'
- r/dumbphones · 240k · soft-sell as the 'software dumb phone'
- r/getdisciplined · 1.5M · short progress threads with screenshots
- r/productivity · 950k · receipts > methods — show the data, not the philosophy
- never link the app on first post — link the website with a demo video

Twitter/X — build in public

\$0 · 2 threads/week, daily check-ins

GOAL 10k cumulative installs · loud build narrative

- post daily Lazy Launcher screenshots from your own use (raw)
- weekly thread: one mechanic explained with the math behind it
- tag and reply-guy with Pieter Levels, Daniel Vassallo, Andrej K., Visa
- DM 5 creators / week with a free Premium link — no asks, no follow-up

Channel Stack — Bootstrap

YouTube — 5–10 creator collabs \$0 (free product, no payment) · 8 weeks outreach, staggered drops

GOAL 200–400k total views · 25–40k installs

- tier 1: Ali Abdaal, Matt D'Avella, Better Ideas — 5M+ subs
- tier 2: Cal Newport (when he tours), Dan Koe, Justin Sung
- send: a 7-day-use video script for them to remix, no embargo
- include: 1 unique receipt screenshot per collab for in-video moment

TikTok organic

\$0 · 3–5 short videos / week, ongoing

GOAL one viral hit (>1M views) → 30–80k installs in one wave

- format: screen recording of receipt + voiceover · 15–25 sec
- format: 'I let an app post my failures to my friends' (surrender mechanic)
- format: 'this app charges you points to open Instagram' (point economy)
- post daily for 6 weeks; one will hit; the rest train the algorithm

Press / podcasts

\$0 · Q2 onwards

GOAL 1 major (Wired/Verge/TechCrunch), 5–8 podcasts, 300k+ impressions

- story for Wired: 'The first launcher built on loss aversion'
- story for Verge: 'You can't uninstall this Android launcher for 72 hours'
- podcast pitch: Hard Fork, The Vergecast, Decoder, My First Million, Indie Hackers
- press kit ready by month 3: screenshots, founder quote, founder bio, 30 sec demo

Content & Community

CONTENT ENGINE — TWICE-WEEKLY CADENCE

LONG-FORM (Tuesday)

- "I let an app post my failures to my friends. 30 days in."
- "The math behind the Form metric (and why your habit tracker is lying to you)"
- "What I learned by hiding my apps for a year"
- "Why Lazy Launcher charges you points to open Instagram"
- founder build logs: weekly, raw, with screenshots

SHORT-FORM (Friday)

- receipt-of-the-week screenshot
- 60-sec demo of one mechanic per video
- user-submitted Sad Self messages
- "this is what my home screen looked like last year" then/now
- thread cadence: monday + thursday, ~6 tweets each

COMMUNITY — DISCORD + BUILT GROUPS

A single Discord, three rooms: #receipts (post yours weekly), #surrender-club (no judgment), #shipping (what did you make this week). Goal is not engagement — goal is texture for new users to read before they install.

AMBASSADOR PROGRAM (Q2 ONWARDS)

Free Lifetime Premium to verified Lazy Launcher users (365 days + 3 shipped projects + 3 vouches) who agree to: (a) post a weekly receipt publicly, (b) write one blog post per quarter, (c) be available for a 30-min interview if asked. Target 30 ambassadors by month 9.

BUILT WRAPPED AS A CONTENT EVENT

Year-end Wrapped (SOCIAL-010) is the biggest content moment of Y1. Every retained user gets a shareable card. Even 20% share rate from 50k retained users = 10k organic posts in week 50–52, late Y1 install spike, and the natural Y2 launch.

12-Month Launch Roadmap

Months are not equal. Three peak weeks carry roughly 40% of total installs: Product Hunt launch (M4), press wave (M7), TikTok viral (M8). Everything else is the consistent compounding that makes those peaks possible.

MONTH

THEME

INSTALLS

CUMULATIVE

SHIPPED

M1

closed alpha · 50 testers

+50

50

Stage 1 MVP feature-complete · invite-only beta

M2

open beta · 500 users

+450

500

Play Store unlisted link · Discord launch · first 5 long-form posts

M3

press kit + ambassador seed

+1.5k

2k

Play Store listing live · first podcast appearance · founder build log starts

M4

Product Hunt launch

+8k

10k

PH #1-of-day target · HN Show 48 hrs later · twitter blowup engineered

M5

first YouTube collab

+7k

17k

Matt D'Avella tier collab · receipts content goes weekly

M6

Stage 2 V1 launch · Track engine

+8k

25k

Sad Self GA · Mantra Gate · HealthConnect · backup live

M7

press push · Wired or Verge

+10k

35k

embargoed press story · 3 podcast drops in one week

M8

TikTok wave · viral hit

+15k

50k

one >1M-view TikTok target · 40+ shorts published this month

M9

ambassador program GA

+10k

60k

30 ambassadors live · receipt wall public · referral loop tightened

M10

second YouTube wave · 3 collabs

+12k

72k

Ali Abdaal-tier · group features highlighted

M11

year-end content prep

+13k

85k

Built Wrapped pre-launch · year-in-review content seeds

M12

Wrapped launch · 100k push

+15k

100k

Built Wrapped GA · year-end thread · Y2 fundraising decision

WHAT CARRIES THE YEAR

Three peaks · seven steady channels · one community. The roadmap holds even if any one peak underperforms, but it breaks if more than one fails. Mitigation in Section 11.

KPIs & Dashboard

One number per layer. If any layer breaks, the model breaks. We track these weekly on the founder's wall, share them publicly month-over-month for accountability.

TOP-LINE

cumulative installs	100k by M12
MAU	60k by M12 (60% retained)
WAU / MAU ratio	> 50%
DAU / MAU ratio	> 25%

FUNNEL

install → onboarded	≥ 55%
onboarded → day 7	≥ 60%
day 7 → day 30	≥ 75%
day 30 → day 90	≥ 80%

VIRAL

k-factor (12-week)	0.4
time to first invite	< 7 days
avg group size	3.5+
dual-streak adoption	≥ 30% of retained

QUALITY

NPS	> 50
churn reason: PMF	< 20%
churn reason: bugs	< 5%
weekly journal entries	≥ 4 / user

REVENUE (M9 ONWARDS)

paid conversion	≥ 5% of WAU
ARPU (annualized)	\$36
MRR by M12	\$15k
LTV / CAC	n/a (CAC = \$0)

BRAND

organic searches / mo	20k by M12
Twitter/X followers	10k by M12
Discord members	5k by M12
press mentions	≥ 15 by M12

Risks & Mitigations

Honest list. None of these are abstract — they have all killed comparable indie launches. Each has a specific mitigation we own.

PMF risk

HIGH

Anti-engagement niche may be smaller than mainstream productivity. Even 100k may be the whole market without crossover.

MITIGATION Reframe at M6: less 'anti-phone,' more 'phone you can finally trust.' Lead with the ambient capture story, not the restriction story.

Google Play takedown

MEDIUM

Launchers with restriction overlays + accessibility services + device admin can flag review. A takedown wipes months of work.

MITIGATION Submit early under 'productivity' not 'wellness.' Get a Play Store contact via Indian dev relations. Mirror to F-Droid + APK Mirror as backup distribution.

Solo-founder burnout

HIGH

Content cadence + dev + community + press is 60+ hr/wk. Most indie launches die here at month 6–8.

MITIGATION Hire a part-time community manager at M6 if \$5k MRR. Outsource short-form video edits to a freelancer. Make the build log itself the content.

Copycat from Forest / Opal

MEDIUM

If we hit ~50k, a funded competitor copies the point economy + sad self mechanic.

MITIGATION Move fast on the social moat (groups + dual streaks). Open-source non-core mechanics to plant your flag. The point economy is a system not a feature — hard to copy partially.

Hardware competitor scales

LOW-MEDIUM

Brick or Light Phone pivots to a software-only offer in the same niche.

MITIGATION Position Lazy Launcher as 'the hardware experience for \$0.' Affiliate / bundle deal with Brick where they recommend our app for in-between hours.

Single channel dependence

HIGH IN M4–M8

If Product Hunt fails AND HackerNews fails AND no TikTok hit by M8, the model is short by 30k+ users.

MITIGATION Hold the M11–M12 Wrapped event as the safety net. Pre-seed Wrapped content from M9. Be ready to do a paid push (~\$5k) in M11 only if all three peaks failed.

Tone backlash

MEDIUM

Sad Self mechanic + public surrender could be read as 'dark pattern' by tech-ethics writers.

Year-Two Setup

Decisions made at the end of Y1 that shape Y2. Default is "don't fundraise" — the unit economics support it. Only deviate if month 12 numbers are above plan.

HIRE WHEN

- Community Manager at \$5k MRR ($\approx$ M6). Part-time, \$1.5k/mo, handle Discord + ambassador program.
- Android dev #2 at \$20k MRR ($\approx$ M11–M12). Full-time, \$5–7k/mo, focus on Stage 3 social tier.
- Content / video editor at \$10k MRR ($\approx$ M9). Freelance, \$1k/mo, edit short-form.
- First hire is never marketing. Founder owns marketing through 250k users.

FUNDRAISE WHEN (OR NEVER)

Default no. If at M12 we are profitable, growing 15%+ MoM, and the social tier is live — keep bootstrapping. Raise only if (a) a hardware partner appears (Brick/Light/Unpluq acquisition or partnership), (b) a Play Store policy threat needs a legal war chest, or (c) clear B2B traction with therapists/teams. Skip pre-seed; go straight to seed at \$5M+ ARR signal.

GEOGRAPHIC EXPANSION

India is the obvious Y2 expansion — your network, Hindi/Tamil localization, culturally-tuned Sad Self voice. Expect lower ARPU ($\sim$ \$8/yr vs \$36 in US) but 5 $\times$ the install volume. Decision gate: M14, after Y1 retention proves in.

THE NARRATIVE FOR Y2

"We built a launcher 100,000 people couldn't quit. Now we're going to make it the operating system for their life." Y2 is when LIFE-001/002 (Bloomberg terminal + auto-insight engine) and SOCIAL-010 (Wrapped) carry the press cycle.